INGLÉS · NIVEL B1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Reported Speech en Inglés B1

Domina el estilo indirecto para reportar conversaciones, noticias y entrevistas con precisión en inglés B1.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Transformar discurso directo a indirecto aplicando backshift, cambios pronominales y de tiempo.

MODELO

"I am tired." She said she was tired. / "Did you pass?" He asked if I had passed.

Al terminar podrás

1. Aplicas el backshift verbal correcto al transformar discurso directo a indirecto
2. Cambias pronombres y expresiones de tiempo correctamente
3. Reportas preguntas de sí/no con if/whether y preguntas con pronombre interrogativo
4. Usas verbos de reporte como say, tell, ask, warn, promise y recommend

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve la práctica y corrige al final. Usa las tres pistas de audio de la lección web para imitar ritmo y entonación.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

El reported speech (estilo indirecto) permite reportar lo que alguien dijo sin usar sus palabras exactas. En B1 debes dominar el backshift verbal (retroceso de tiempos), los cambios de pronombres y las expresiones de tiempo. Es esencial para IELTS, Cambridge y exámenes de inglés.

¿Qué es el reported speech y por qué es clave en B1?

El reported speech (estilo indirecto) es la forma de reportar lo que alguien dijo usando nuestras propias palabras, sin repetir exactamente sus palabras. En lugar de "She said: 'I am tired'", decimos "She said she was tired."

En el nivel B1 es fundamental porque aparece en textos periodísticos, entrevistas, narraciones y en los exámenes Cambridge PET, IELTS y TOEFL. Dominar el backshift y los cambios pronominales marca la diferencia entre un nivel B1 básico y uno sólido.

El backshift: retroceso de tiempos verbales

La regla principal del reported speech es el backshift: los tiempos verbales "retroceden" un paso en el pasado. Present simple past simple ("I work" "she worked"). Past simple past perfect ("I worked" "he had worked"). Will would ("I will help" "she said she would help"). Can could, must had to.

El backshift ocurre cuando el verbo de reporte está en pasado (said, told, asked). Si el verbo de reporte está en presente (says, tells), no hay backshift: "She says she is tired." (presente) vs "She said she was tired." (pasado).

Directo	Indirecto (backshift)	Cambio
I am studying.	She said she was studying.	present past
I passed the exam.	He said he had passed the exam.	past simple past perfect
I will call tomorrow.	She said she would call the next day.	will would
I can help you.	He said he could help me.	can could

Cambios de pronombres y expresiones de tiempo

Los pronombres cambian según el contexto: I he/she, we they, you I (si la persona reportada te hablaba a ti), my his/her, our their. Siempre piensa quién está hablando y quién está escuchando.

Las expresiones de tiempo también cambian: today that day, yesterday the day before / the previous day, tomorrow the next day / the following day, now then, here there, last week the week before, next year the following year.

Reported questions: preguntas en estilo indirecto

Las preguntas reportadas tienen una estructura diferente: NO hay inversión sujeto-verbo, y llevan un auxiliar como en una oración afirmativa. Para preguntas de sí/no, se usa if o whether: "Are you coming?" He asked if she was coming / whether she was coming.

Para preguntas con pronombre interrogativo (who, what, where, when, why, how), el pronombre interrogativo introduce la cláusula: "Where do you live?" She asked where I lived. Nota: "do/does/did" desaparece en el estilo indirecto.

Verbos de reporte más allá de say y tell

En B1 debes conocer más verbos de reporte: warn + not to (advertir): "He warned me not to be late." / promise + to (prometer): "She promised to help." / recommend + -ing (recomendar): "The guide recommended visiting the museum." / refuse + to (negarse): "He refused to sign the contract."

Estos verbos tienen estructuras propias: ask + to-infinitive para órdenes ("She asked me to close the window." = "Could you close the window?"); advise + to-infinitive para consejos ("The doctor advised me to rest more.").

¿Cómo se forma el estilo indirecto (reported speech) en inglés?

El verbo introductor (say, tell) suele ir en pasado y el verbo citado "retrocede" un tiempo: present past, past past perfect, will would, can could. "I am tired" "She said (that) she was tired". También cambian los pronombres y las expresiones de tiempo.

¿Cómo cambian los tiempos verbales en reported speech?

Retroceden un paso: am/is/are → was/were; do/does → did; have → had; will → would; can → could; must → had to. "now" → "then", "today" → "that day", "tomorrow" → "the next day". Si lo dicho sigue siendo verdad, el cambio es opcional.

¿Cuál es la diferencia entre "say" y "tell" en reported speech?

"tell" necesita un objeto (a quién): "She told me that…". "say" no lleva objeto directo de persona: "She said that…" (no "she said me"). Error típico del hispanohablante: "she said me" → "she told me".

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

Subject + reporting verb + (that) + backshifted clause / Subject + asked + if/wh-word + backshifted clause

Decide en este orden

1. Backshift: present simple → past simple; past simple → past perfect; will → would; can → could; must → had to
2. Pronombres: I → he/she; we → they; you → I/he/she; my → his/her; our → their
3. Expresiones de tiempo: today → that day; yesterday → the day before; tomorrow → the next day; now → then; here → there
4. say vs tell: say (no objeto directo) → She said she was tired. / tell + persona → She told me she was tired.
5. Preguntas sí/no → asked + if/whether + sujeto + verbo (sin inversión)
6. Preguntas con wh- → asked + pronombre interrogativo + sujeto + verbo (sin inversión)

Discurso directo	Backshift	Discurso indirecto
"I am happy."	am → was	She said she was happy.
"I will call you."	will → would	He said he would call me.

Errores frecuentes

× "She said me she was tired." → "She told me she was tired." — tell siempre va con objeto: told me/him/her/them.

× "He asked where was she." → "He asked where she was." — en reported questions no hay inversión sujeto-verbo.

× "She said she is coming." → "She said she was coming." — aplica el backshift correctamente.

02 · MAPA VISUAL

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

"I love this city." She said she loved that city.	"Me encanta esta ciudad." Dijo que le encantaba esa ciudad.
"We will arrive tomorrow." They said they would arrive the next day.	"Llegaremos mañana." Dijeron que llegarían al día siguiente.
"Did you pass the test?" She asked if I had passed the test.	"¿Pasaste el examen?" Preguntó si yo había pasado el examen.
"Where do you study?" He asked where I studied.	"¿Dónde estudias?" Preguntó dónde estudiaba yo.
"I can help you." She said she could help me.	"Puedo ayudarte." Dijo que podía ayudarme.
"Don't be late!" He warned me not to be late.	"¡No llegues tarde!" Me advirtió que no llegara tarde.
"I must finish the report." She said she had to finish the report.	"Debo terminar el informe." Dijo que tenía que terminar el informe.
"I passed!" He told me he had passed.	"¡Pasé!" Me dijo que había pasado.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

21 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

Identifica el backshift correcto

1. "The exam is next Friday." The teacher said the exam ___ the following Friday. Opciones: was · is · were · will be

2. "I will send you the report." She said she ___ me the report. Opciones: would send · will send · sends · sent

3. "I passed all my exams!" He told us he ___ all his exams. Opciones: had passed · passed · has passed · pass

4. "You must finish the project today." The manager told us we ___ the project that day. Opciones: had to finish · must finish · have to finish · would finish

5. "I am ready." — direct speech She ___ she was ready. Opciones: said · told · said me · told to

6. "Do you like Bogotá?" She asked me if I ___ Bogotá. Opciones: liked · like · do like · liking

7. "Where is the metro station?" She asked where the metro station ___. Opciones: was · is · were · had been

8. "I will help you prepare for the IELTS." Dario promised ___ me prepare for the IELTS. Opciones: to help · helping · help · helped

Transforma el discurso directo

9. "I am looking for a new job." (Carlos said) Carlos said he _____ for a new _____. Opciones: was looking · is looking · were looking · has looked / job · work · career · position

10. "Can you speak Portuguese?" (The interviewer asked Maria) The interviewer asked Maria if she _____ speak _____. Opciones: could · can · would · will / Portuguese · Spanish · English · French

11. "You must rest and drink more water." (The doctor told her) The doctor told her she _____ rest and drink more _____. Opciones: had to · must · should · would / water · juice · coffee · tea

12. "Where are you going for your holidays?" (She asked me) She asked me where I _____ for my _____. Opciones: was going · am going · went · would go / holidays · holiday · vacation · break

La entrevista de trabajo

13. During the interview, the manager said the company _____ (is) growing fast. She asked me if I _____ (have) experience with data analysis. I said I _____ (have worked) with Excel and Python. She told me they _____ (will offer) a decision the following week. She also warned me not _____ (be) late for the second interview. She said she _____ (can) see potential in my profile. Finally, she asked where I _____ (see) myself in five years.

Escribe el reported speech

14. Direct: "I am preparing for the IELTS exam." (Ana said) Ana said she _____ for the IELTS exam.
Direct: "We will finish the project tomorrow." (They said) They said they _____ the project the following day.
Direct: "Did you study abroad?" (She asked him) She asked if he _____ abroad.
Direct: "You must submit the form today." (The office told us) The office told us we _____ the form that day.
Direct: "I can speak three languages." (He said) He said he _____ three languages.

Reporta la conversación

15. Tu profesor dijo: "You are making excellent progress." Reporta lo que dijo usando told.

_____

16. Tu amiga dijo: "I'm going to visit Cartagena next month." Reporta lo que dijo.

_____

17. Tu compañero te preguntó: "Have you registered for the TOEFL?" Reporta la pregunta.

_____

18. La profesora advirtió: "Don't use your phone during the exam." Reporta la advertencia.

_____

Misión: Reporta una entrevista

19. Reporta algo positivo que dijo la persona entrevistada (usa said + that + backshift).

_____

20. Reporta una pregunta que tú le hiciste durante la entrevista (usa asked + if/where/what/how).

_____

21. Reporta un consejo que te dio la persona usando advised/recommended + to + infinitivo o -ing.

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. was — present simple (is) past simple (was) con backshift. "is next Friday" "was the following Friday".
2. would send — will would en backshift: "I will send" "she would send".
3. had passed — past simple (passed) past perfect (had passed) en backshift.
4. had to finish — must had to en backshift cuando se reporta en pasado.
5. said — say no lleva objeto directo de persona: She said she was ready. (NO "said me").
6. liked — Pregunta de sí/no asked if + sujeto + verbo backshifted: asked if I liked.
7. was — Pregunta wh- asked where + sujeto + verbo backshifted. Sin inversión sujeto-verbo.
8. to help — promise + to-infinitive: "promised to help" — estructura fija del verbo de reporte.
9. was looking / job — present continuous (am looking) past continuous (was looking) + pronombre I he. El sustantivo "job" se mantiene igual en reported speech.
10. could / Portuguese — can could en backshift: "Can you" "if she could". El idioma mencionado en la pregunta original es Portuguese.
11. had to / water — must had to en backshift: "You must rest" "she had to rest". El sustantivo "water" se mantiene del discurso original.
12. was going / holidays — present continuous (are going) past continuous (was going). "you" "I". "holidays" se mantiene del original.
13. was / had / had worked / would offer / to be / could / saw — present simple "is" past simple "was" con backshift. present simple "have" past simple "had" con backshift. past simple/present perfect past perfect: "had worked". will would en backshift: "will offer" "would offer". warn + not to + infinitivo: "warned me not to be late". can could en backshift: "She can see" "she could see". Pregunta wh- en pasado: "where I saw myself" (backshift de "see" "saw").
14. was preparing / would finish / had studied / had to submit / could speak — present continuous past continuous: "am preparing" "was preparing". will would: "will finish" "would finish". past simple past perfect: "Did you study" "if he had studied". must had to: "must submit" "had to submit". can could: "can speak" "could speak".
15. My teacher told me I was making excellent progress. — Backshift: am making was making. Pronombre: you I. Usa told + persona para tell.
16. She said she was going to visit Cartagena the following month. — Backshift: am going was going. Cambio de tiempo: next month the following month.
17. He asked me if I had registered for the TOEFL. — Pregunta de sí/no asked if + sujeto + had + participio (backshift de present perfect past perfect).
18. The teacher warned us not to use our phones during the exam. — warn/tell + persona + not to + infinitivo para órdenes negativas reportadas.
19. She said that learning English had changed her life completely. — Usa: He/She said (that) + oración con backshift. That es opcional pero formal.
20. I asked how she had learned to speak four languages. — Pregunta wh-: asked + pronombre interrogativo + sujeto + verbo (sin inversión).
21. She advised me to practise speaking every day with native speakers. — advise + persona + to + infinitivo / recommend + -ing: ambas son estructuras correctas para consejos.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.